

Citi Placement Drive Experience

Ganesh S (2022115035)

1 About the Company

Citicorp Services India Private Limited provides financial services. The company offers commercial vehicle and construction equipment lending, trade advances, loans against securities, and consumer loan services. Citicorp Services India serves customers worldwide.

2 About the Role

The PBWM (Personal Banking & Wealth Management) division at Citi focuses on offering financial services and personalized solutions to individual clients, ranging from everyday banking to wealth management and investment services. This division plays a crucial role in managing client relationships, addressing their financial needs, and helping them achieve personal financial goals. The role involved product development as an Application Programmer with the tech stack primarily based on Java.

3 Preparation Strategy

- Focus on mastering basic-medium aptitude questions including comprehensions, statement-based questions, and mathematical aptitude such as number systems, probability, and equations solving.
- Strengthen technical skills in databases (PostgreSQL, MySQL), Object Oriented Programming (C++ or Java), and common data structures (arrays, linked lists, stacks, queues).
- Practice coding questions similar to those in placement tests
- Be well-prepared with projects mentioned in your resume, especially coding and database management aspects.

4 Placement Drive Experience

4.1 Online Test

The online test comprised four sections:

- Section 1: Basic-medium aptitude questions (14 questions in 14 minutes) involving comprehensions and statements.
- Section 2: Mathematical aptitude (16 questions in 16 minutes), including problems on number systems, profit/loss, probability, and equation solving.
- Section 3: Technical MCQs (12 questions in 15 minutes), which covered program outputs, error correction, and database management (DBMS) concepts.
- Section 4: Coding questions:
 - Finding the largest and smallest prime numbers in a range.
 - Counting characters in a string that are neither alphabets nor whitespaces.

Around 25 students were shortlisted for interviews after this round.

4.2 Technical Interview

The technical interview had two interviewers. Key highlights include:

- Introduction and project discussion: I explained one of my projects.
- SQL questions: I created a table in MySQL and discussed SQL injection, including prevention methods like parameterized queries and filtering operations. I was asked to write the code for this.
- C++ coding: I wrote the Fibonacci series using both recursive and iterative methods to demonstrate my understanding of C++.
- API usage: I explained the use of APIs in my project, and I was asked to write code for linking Google Maps API, which I implemented using the Oauth library in a Flask environment.
- General questions: Why Citi? What do you know about Citi? I also discussed my favorite subject, Java, from the current semester in web technologies.

Thirteen students were selected for the HR interview from this round.

4.3 HR Interview

This round was short for most candidates due to time constraints, but I extended mine by preparing well:

- The interviewer asked if there was anything I had not mentioned in my resume. I shared real-world problem-solving projects, which were not part of the coursework projects listed on my resume.
- I discussed my experience with a project aimed at helping the homeless, pitched during a 7-day camp organized by Thozhan. The interviewer appreciated my initiative and motivation.
- We also had a conversation about hobbies and work-life balance. The interviewer asked what I would be doing if there was no engineering domain, and I answered "service."

In the PBWM domain, 6 students were selected, while 7 students were selected in the ICG (React, Angular JS-based) domain.

5 Tips and Tricks

- CITI usually does not focus heavily on Data Structures and Algorithms (DSA) from my experience. Instead, ensure you're strong in database management (PostgreSQL, MySQL), object-oriented programming (C++ or Java), and basic aptitude puzzles.
- At the same time, have a good grasp of data structures like arrays, linked lists, stacks, and queues to stay in a safe zone.
- Do not include skills or projects in your resume if you're not confident about them.
- Generate possible questions from your resume and projects, and be prepared to code or explain anything listed there.
- During interviews, even if you're unsure about something, handle it calmly and politely. Be confident while speaking.
- GPA is not everything—if you have a lower GPA, make up for it by shining with extra skills and eagerness to learn.